



Proposed Capstone Project Concept		Priority No. 1
Name and Position of Scholar:	Jovel J. Oberio Education Program Supervisor	Endorsed by:
Office/Agency of Scholar:	Department of Education – Negros Island Region	for: <i>[Signature]</i> Arlene G. Bermejo, CESO V Schools Division Superintendent
		Date:

Working Title:	SGC SmartTrack: AI-Powered School Governance Analytics, Decision Support and Technical Assistance Management System
Innovation Priority Area of the Proposed CP:	Public Administration - Innovations that empower participatory governance to ensure collaborative, people- centered, reliable, accountable, and efficient government institutions.

What is the project idea? (Provide a simple illustration or suitable graphics to visualize the project concept.)

SGC SmartTrack is an integrated web and mobile Governance Intelligence Platform to strengthen monitoring, evaluation and continuous improvement of School Governance Council (SGC) functionality in public schools. The system digitizes the Department of Education's (DepEd) School Governance Council Functionality Assessment and Validation Tool and integrates Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered governance analytics, decision support, and technical assistance management to turn governance data into useful insights for continuous school improvement.

SGC SmartTrack is not just a traditional digital system that automates data collection and reporting. It is an intelligent governance management platform that supports schools, Schools Governance and Operations Division (SGOD), Public Schools District Supervisors (PSDSs) and education leaders in the entire governance improvement cycle. Under the present DepEd validation indicators, schools encode only the required governance information and supporting evidence. Subsequently, the system automatically compiles governance data, rates functionality, assesses governance performance, identifies strengths and governance gaps, compares results with division standards, predicts governance risks, and generates AI-supported recommendations that are fully aligned with DepEd policies and governance indicators.

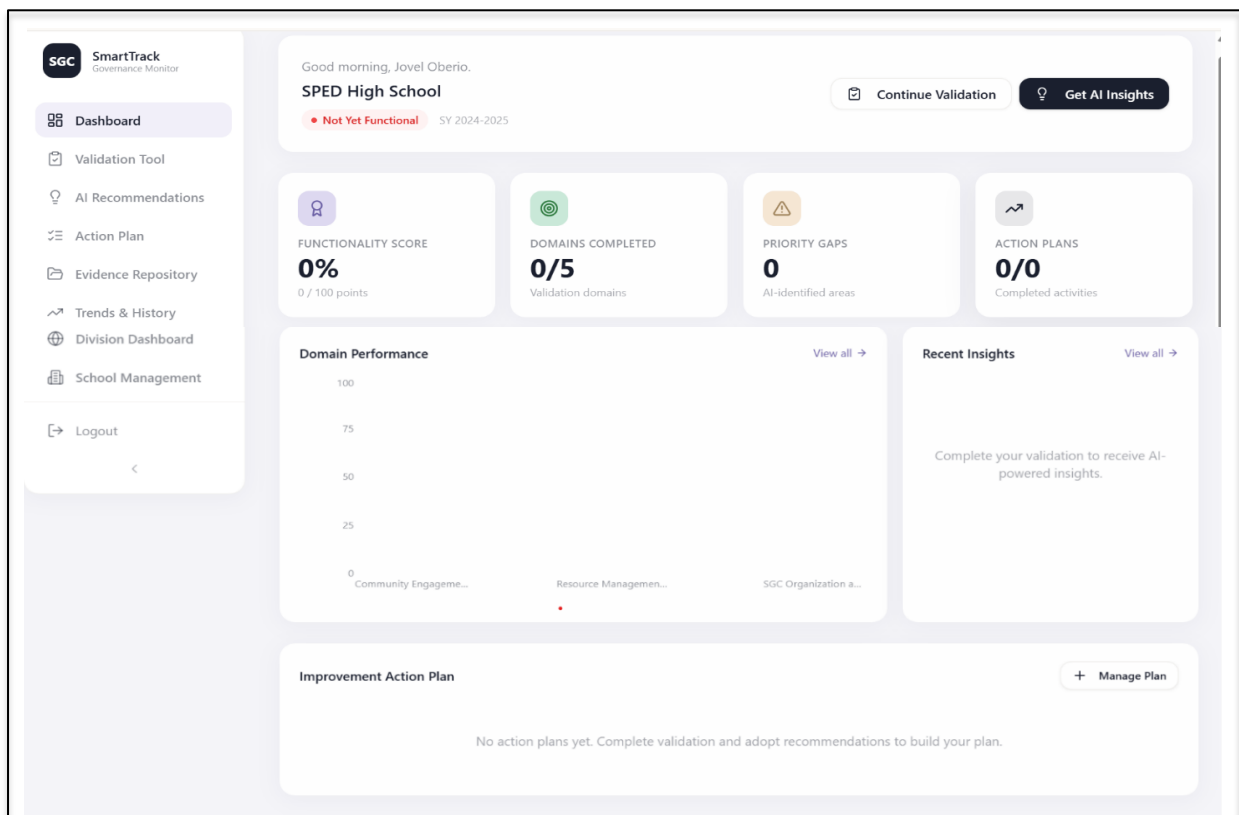
A key innovation of the platform is its Governance Analytics Engine, which transforms governance assessment results into meaningful intelligence. Leveraging advanced analytics and Responsible Artificial Intelligence, the system generates School Governance Improvement Plans, recommends governance interventions, prioritizes schools for technical assistance, tracks implementation progress, and evaluates the effectiveness of governance interventions over time. Hence, the AI is an explainable and transparent decision support system to support education leaders in making timely, evidence-based and context-sensitive governance decisions rather than replacing professional judgment.

The platform also has a Technical Assistance Management System for Schools Governance

automatically identify schools that require priority support, recommends appropriate interventions (e.g. coaching, mentoring, training, or policy guidance), schedules technical assistance activities, tracks implementation status, and evaluates the outcomes of interventions. This would change technical assistance from a reactive compliance process into a proactive, data-driven and strategic governance support mechanism.

SGC SmartTrack has a comprehensive Responsible AI Framework which is built on the pillars of explainability, transparency, fairness, accountability, privacy protection and oversight by humans to ensure ethical and trustworthy use of Artificial Intelligence in public administration. All AI recommendations are accompanied by confidence scores, plain-language explanations, indicator attribution, and user validation capabilities to ensure that final governance decisions remain in the hands of school leaders, SGC members, and DepEd personnel.

In addition to governance monitoring, SGC SmartTrack facilitates the wider application of School-Based Management (SBM) by integrating governance analytics with SBM principles. It further improves stakeholder engagement, governance documentation, transparency and accountability, and offers education leaders a comprehensive Governance Intelligence Dashboard to aid strategic planning and organizational decision-making. With its integrated governance analytics, predictive intelligence and AI-assisted technical assistance management, the platform supports DepEd's digital transformation agenda and helps establish a culture of continuous governance improvement among schools.



Note: KEEP YOUR ANSWERS WITHIN THIS PAGE. They must be short and concise but clear enough for the reader to understand your concept.

Evidence-Based Inquiry

What problem or opportunity does your project seek to address and what evidence or data support this? What theory of change do you intend to use?

The Department of Education (DepEd) through DepEd Order No. 26, s. 2022 recognizes the School Governance Council (SGC) as an important vehicle in improving participatory governance, stakeholder engagement, transparency, accountability and shared decision-making in public schools. SGCs are meant to establish and operate a formal venue for the active involvement of parents, community members, local government units, private organizations, alumni and other education stakeholders in the planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of school programs to support effective School-Based Management (SBM).

However, the implementation and monitoring of School Governance Councils continues to be a big challenge in many schools. The DepEd's nationwide SGC Functionality Assessment and Validation revealed that many public schools have yet to establish fully functional School Governance Councils or continue to function at the Beginning or Developing levels of functionality, showing that meaningful stakeholder participation and governance practices are still uneven across the basic education system. The findings show the continued need to strengthen governance capacities, enhance stakeholder engagement and institutionalize good governance practices in schools.

One of the main challenges is that governance assessment is still very manual, fragmented and compliance driven. School Heads spend a lot of time coding assessment results, putting together documentary evidence, consolidating reports and

Citizen-centric

How will the ordinary citizens or the transacting public benefit from your project?

The primary stakeholders of SGC SmartTrack are the ordinary citizens that directly interact with public schools, particularly the parents and guardians, learners, local government units, community groups, private sector partners, alumni associations and other education stakeholders. The project improves the effectiveness of School Governance Councils (SGCs) by providing more opportunities for meaningful citizen participation in school governance and making governance processes more transparent, responsive and evidence based.

For parents and guardians: The project advocates for increased parental and guardian involvement in school decision making by identifying the areas of lack of stakeholders' involvement and providing AI-assisted recommendations for enhanced parental involvement. A more functional SGC has parents as active partners in the planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of programs and not as passive recipients of education services. Increased involvement of parents helps in improved attendance of the learners, academic performance and better school-community relations.

Learners are the final beneficiaries of the project, though they do not use the application directly. If the School Governance Councils are more effective, school improvement planning is improved, allocation of resources is more efficient, partnerships with the community are

interpreting validation indicators. Similarly, the Schools Governance and Operations Division (SGOD) and Public Schools District Supervisors manually review reports, identify schools in need of technical assistance and determine interventions. These administrative processes are repetitive, delay decision-making, increase the risk of human error, and hinder the timely use of governance information for school improvement.

The existing DepEd School Governance Council Functionality Assessment and Validation Tool is effective in measuring governance performance, however, there is a significant gap in that it does not provide an integrated digital platform that automatically analyzes governance data, identifies governance gaps, generates evidence-based recommendations, prioritizes schools requiring technical assistance, and monitors the implementation of governance improvement interventions. Hence, governance assessment turns into a compliance exercise rather than a continuous improvement process.

At the same time, the Department of Education has prioritized digital transformation, evidence-based planning and data-driven decision making through the Basic Education Development Plan (BEDP) 2030 and other modernization efforts. This project aims to introduce an opportunity to use digital technologies and Artificial Intelligence (AI) to improve governance systems, while increasing efficiency, transparency and public accountability.

SGC SmartTrack+ tackles these problems by transforming the current governance assessment process into a comprehensive AI-Powered Governance Analytics, Decision Support and Technical Assistance Management System. The platform digitizes the official SGC Functionality Assessment and Validation Tool, instead of replacing the current DepEd validation process, and enhances it with governance analytics, predictive intelligence, and Responsible

stronger, and learning environments respond more effectively to learners' needs for academic, health, safety and well-being. Better governance enables schools to deliver quality educational programmes that foster learner success.

SGC SmartTrack also improves collaboration with community stakeholders including local government units, barangay officials, civil society organizations, private institutions, and alumni associations, by equipping schools with data-driven insights on partnership opportunities and governance priorities. The system allows schools to engage stakeholders based on identified needs to enhance more community ownership of education and shared responsibility for school improvement.

The project also promotes transparency and accountability in school governance which benefits the transacting public. Digital documentation, centralized records, automated reporting and governance dashboards provide stakeholders with greater confidence that school decisions are evidence-informed, aligned with DepEd standards and backed by proper documentation.

For citizens who routinely transact with schools such as parents, partner organizations and community volunteers, the platform helps to make governance processes more efficient by reducing administrative workload and allowing school leaders to spend more time on stakeholder engagement and service delivery. Schools can respond more quickly to community concerns, communicate governance successes more effectively and implement improvement programs more efficiently.

At the division level, SGC SmartTrack provides the Schools Governance and Operations Division (SGOD) with the ability to provide faster, more targeted and

Artificial Intelligence. Schools will simply encode the needed governance information and upload supporting documents based on existing DepEd indicators. The system will automatically consolidate assessment results, calculate functionality ratings, identify governance strengths and weaknesses, benchmark school performance, generate School Governance Improvement Plans, suggest governance interventions, and support the Schools Governance and Operations Division in prioritising technical assistance around genuine governance needs.

The project is founded on a Results-Based Theory of Change that is rooted in principles of digital transformation, collaborative governance and continuous organizational improvement.

This theory assumes that providing schools with an integrated digital governance platform that automates governance assessment, analyzes the School Governance Council's performance using Responsible Artificial Intelligence, identifies governance gaps, generates evidence-based recommendations, and supports SGOD to provide timely technical assistance will enable the School Heads, School Governance Councils, and education supervisors to make better governance decisions, implement targeted governance interventions, strengthen stakeholder participation, and improve School Governance Council's functionality continuously.

This Theory of Change frames SGC SmartTrack not just as a digital monitoring application but as a governance intelligence platform that turns governance assessment into a cycle of analysis, decision support, technical assistance, implementation, monitoring, and continuous improvement, in full alignment with the Department of Education's vision of responsive, participatory, and technology-enabled educational governance.

evidence-based technical assistance to schools. Education supervisors can use real-time governance analysis to identify schools needing immediate assistance by bypassing manual reports and ensuring government funds go where they are most needed. This means better delivery of public services, and better outcomes for school communities.

Innovative

What innovation are you creating to add value and improve the existing situation/system?

SGC SmartTrack revolutionizes the current School Governance Council (SGC) Functionality Assessment by turning it from a manual, compliance-oriented process into a AI-Powered Governance Analytics, Decision Support, and Technical Assistance Management System. The project is a comprehensive Governance Intelligence Platform that enables continuous governance improvement through data analytics, Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI), and evidence-based decision support rather than just digitizing the existing DepEd School Governance Council Functionality Assessment and Validation Tool.

The core innovation of the project is the integration of a Governance Intelligence Engine that allows the automatic processing of governance assessment data based on DepEd validation indicators. Once the digital assessment is completed by schools, and the necessary Means of Verification (MOVs) are uploaded, the system automatically calculates SGC functionality ratings, performs indicator-level performance assessment, identifies governance strengths and weaknesses, detects governance gaps, benchmarks schools against division-wide performance, and generates AI-supported recommendations pertinent to each school's governance needs. This turns governance assessment into a continuous improvement process with the support of actionable intelligence rather than a static evaluation.

Second, the AI-Assisted Decision Support System is a major innovation, providing personalized recommendations to school leaders and governance teams instead of leaving them to make sense of assessment results on their own. The platform automatically generates School Governance Improvement Plans (SGIPs), suggests governance interventions, highlights priority activities, suggests timelines for

High Impact

What is the relevance of this project to the mandate of your agency? What could be its distinct contribution to the field of development management?

The proposed SGC SmartTrack: An AI-Powered Governance Analytics, Decision Support, and Technical Assistance Management System for School Governance Councils project directly supports the constitutional and statutory mandate of the Department of Education (DepEd) to protect and promote the right of every Filipino to quality, equitable, culture-based, and complete basic education. The project in particular supports the DepEd's mandate to strengthen school governance, enhance stakeholder participation, improve organizational performance and ensure effective implementation of School-Based Management (SBM) as a strategy to improve learner outcomes.

The project operationalizes the objectives of Republic Act No. 9155 (Governance of Basic Education Act of 2001) which decentralizes decision-making and empowers schools through School-Based Management. The project supports the implementation of DepEd Order No. 26, s. 2022 which institutionalizes School Governance Councils (SGCs) as mechanisms for participatory governance by encouraging parents, local government units, community organizations, civil society and other stakeholders to actively participate in school planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation it digitally empowers these governance structures in a systematic and effective way by digitalizing the School Governance Council Functionality Assessment and Validation Tool and integrating governance analytics and Responsible Artificial Intelligence (AI) within it.

SGC SmartTrack is aligned with the Basic Education Development Plan (BEDP) 2030, that acknowledges digital

implementation, and aligns all recommendations with the Department of Education's SGC indicators and School-Based Management (SBM) framework. This allows schools to move from assessment to strategic action, reducing administrative burden and improving planning efficiency.

A Technical Assistance Management System, a new innovation designed specifically for the Schools Governance and Operations Division (SGOD), will also be introduced in the project. The system employs real-time governance analysis to pinpoint schools that need urgent support, ranks technical assistance based on governance performance, suggests suitable interventions such as coaching, mentoring, policy advice, or capacity development, and tracks the execution and results of these interventions. Such a move would shift technical assistance from being a reactive, compliance-driven task to a proactive, data-informed management process in which resources are directed to the schools in greatest need.

A Responsible AI Framework is another unique innovation incorporated into the governance platform. Unlike traditional artificial intelligence systems that act as "black boxes," SGC SmartTrack ensures all recommendations made by AI are transparent, explainable and can be overseen by humans. The platform also provides confidence scores, explains the governance indicators behind each recommendation, tags AI outputs, and requires users to accept, edit, or reject recommendations before implementation. It also includes audit trails, bias monitoring, privacy safeguards, and accountability mechanisms to ensure ethical and trustworthy use of AI in educational governance.

The platform also adds value through Governance Analytics Dashboards which provide real-time visualization of SGC functionality, stakeholder participation, governance trends, technical assistance status and readiness of School-Based

transformation, evidence-based decision-making, organizational excellence and strengthened governance as key strategies to improve the quality and efficiency of the Philippine basic education system. The SGC SmartTrack+ with its centralized governance data, real-time analytics, predictive insights and AI-assisted recommendations, is a tool that can help DepEd to transition to a more data-driven, technology-enabled and responsive education management system. It also strengthens the Schools Governance and Operations Division (SGOD) by providing a platform for focused technical assistance, effective monitoring and strategic allocation of resources based on actual governance performance.

At the operational level, the project addresses longstanding challenges in governance monitoring such as fragmented documentation, manual consolidation of reports, delayed technical assistance and limited use of governance data for planning and decision making. SGC SmartTrack+ includes digital assessment, governance analytics, AI-powered decision support, automated School Governance Improvement Plans (SGIPs), and a Technical Assistance Management Module to help schools and the Division Office transition from compliance-based monitoring to continuous governance improvement.

In the Development Management perspective, the project shows how Responsible Artificial Intelligence and Governance Intelligence can be leveraged to enhance public sector governance and organizational development unlike other digital government initiatives that tend to focus on automating transactions or digitizing records. This project goes a step further, converting governance data into strategic intelligence to inform planning, decision-making, resource allocation, monitoring and technical assistance. It

Management. Interactive dashboards, governance heat maps, benchmarking tools and predictive analytics allow School Heads, Public Schools District Supervisors, SGOD personnel and education leaders to make faster, evidence-based decisions and to proactively address governance issues before they impact school performance.

The innovation of SGC SmartTrack is that it integrates digital governance, governance analytics, Responsible Artificial Intelligence, predictive decision support, and technical assistance management into a single, comprehensive platform. It transforms governance monitoring from a mere reporting requirement to an intelligent management system that fosters continuous organizational learning, strengthens the School Governance Council's functionality, improves the implementation of School-Based Management, enhances stakeholder participation, and advances the digital transformation agenda of the Department of Education. SGC SmartTrack+ converts governance data into strategic intelligence, a scalable and sustainable innovation that improves public service delivery and promotes more transparent, accountable and participatory governance in Philippine basic education.

positions digital technology as not simply an administrative tool but as an enabler of institutional learning, adaptive governance and continuous organizational improvement.

The project also promotes core Development Management principles including participatory governance, collaborative leadership, evidence-based policy making, public sector innovation through digital means, organizational capacity development and results-based management. Decision makers have access to AI assisted analytics and governance dashboards to provide timely, reliable information enabling proactive, not reactive, interventions. The Technical Assistance Management Module helps the organization to increase its capacity by providing support that responds to the real governance needs of schools, thereby increasing the efficiency and effectiveness of the use of public resource.

SGC SmartTrack+ is also part of the growing field of AI-enabled public administration by embedding Responsible AI principles into educational governance. These principles include transparency, explainability, accountability, fairness, privacy protection and oversight by humans. This points out that artificial intelligence can be used responsibly to augment human decision making while maintaining professional judgment, public accountability and citizen trust. Thus, the project is a practical model of ethical digital transformation of government institutions.